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Older Workers Face a Tough Return to Work

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 263 words · L2



고령 노동자의 재취업 시장

As populations age across many countries, more people over 50 are looking for jobs after a career break or early retirement. However, re-entering the workforce at an older age is rarely straightforward, and the challenges these workers face are drawing growing attention from employers and policymakers alike.

One major obstacle is age discrimination. Many employers still prefer younger candidates, assuming older applicants lack digital skills or cannot adapt to new workplace environments. This bias can make the job search long and discouraging, even

when the older worker has decades of valuable experience.

The financial impact can also be serious. Research shows that older workers — particularly women — who return to employment after a period of unemployment often accept significantly lower wages than they earned before. Some studies suggest earnings losses of around 25 percent for older women in this situation, a gap that is difficult to close over time.

At the same time, aging societies actually need these workers. As birth rates fall and the older population grows, labor shortages are becoming a real concern in many industries.

Experienced workers in fields such as healthcare, education, and skilled trades are especially hard to replace.

Some companies are beginning to respond. Flexible hours, phased retirement programs, and retraining opportunities can all help older employees stay in or return to the workforce. Experts point to mentorship roles as one area where older workers offer clear value that younger employees cannot easily provide.

For policymakers, supporting re-employment programs and updating anti-discrimination laws may be key steps toward building a workforce that works for all generations.

한글 요약

여러 국가에서 인구 고령화가 심화되면서 50세 이상 근로자들의 재취업 수요가 증가하고 있으나, 연령 차별과 임금 손실 등 심각한 장벽이 존재한다. 특히 실업 후 재취업한 고령 여성의 경우 이전 대비 약 25퍼센트의 소득 감소를 겪는 것으로 나타났다. 반면, 출생률 하락으로 인한 노동력 부족 문제가 현실화되면서 의료·교육·숙련 기술 분야를 중심으로 고령 근로자의 필요성이 높아지고 있다. 이에 따라 유연 근무제, 재교육 프로그램, 반차별법 강화 등을 통해 고령 근로자의 노동 시장 참여를 지원하는 정책적 노력이 요구된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

discrimination 차별

bias 편견, 선입견

labor shortage 노동력 부족

phased 단계적인

retraining 재교육, 재훈련

mentorship 멘토 역할, 지도

policymaker 정책 입안자

Cities Find New Ways to Reuse Water

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 141 words · L1



물 재이용 기술의 확산

Access to clean water is becoming harder in many parts of the world. As droughts grow more frequent due to climate change, cities and governments are looking at water reuse technologies as a practical solution.

Water reuse means treating used or wastewater so it can be used again — for farming, industry, or even drinking. Traditional water systems rely on large, centralized plants, but smaller, local treatment systems are now being tested in cities across the

United States, Australia, and parts of Europe. These systems can clean water on-site and return it to use much faster.

Regulations around water reuse are still catching up in many countries. Some governments are updating their standards to allow more reuse projects to move forward. Researchers note that reliable testing and safety checks are essential before treated water can be widely accepted by the public.

한글 요약

기후변화로 인한 가뭄이 심화되면서 전 세계적으로 깨끗한 물 확보가 어려워지고 있으며, 물 재이용 기술이 현실적인 대안으로 부상하고 있다. 물 재이용은 폐수를 처리하여 농업·산업·음용 등 다양한 용도로 재활용하는 방식으로, 미국·호주·유럽 등지에서는 기존의 대형 중앙집중식 시설 대신 소규모 현지 처리 시스템이 시험 도입되고 있다. 다만 많은 국가에서 관련 규제가 기술 발전 속도를 따라가지 못하고 있어, 일부 정부는 재이용 사업 확대를 위해 기준 개정을 추진 중이다. 연구자들은 처리된 물이 대중의 신뢰를 얻기 위해서는 철저한 검사와 안전 점검이 선행되어야 한다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

drought	가뭄	regulation	규정, 법규
wastewater	폐수, 하수	on-site	현장에서
treatment	처리, 정화	reliable	믿을 수 있는, 신뢰할 수 있는
centralized	중앙 집중식의		

When Food Aid Hurts More Than It Helps

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 300 words · L3



식량 원조와 자립의 딜레마

Every year, wealthy nations send millions of tonnes of food to countries facing hunger and crisis. The intention is to save lives, and in many emergencies it does exactly that. However, aid organizations and economists are increasingly asking whether food aid sometimes creates problems that last long after the crisis has passed.

When large quantities of free food arrive in a region, local farmers often struggle to compete with something that costs nothing. Markets can collapse, and farmers who might otherwise sell their harvests earn little to nothing, which pushes them further into poverty over time.

This cycle has been documented in several African and Middle Eastern countries. In

Yemen, for example, years of conflict-related food aid have kept many communities dependent on outside support rather than rebuilding their own food systems. Critics argue that dependency, not recovery, becomes the real outcome in such cases.

Some humanitarian organizations have responded by shifting from direct food handouts to cash assistance programs. Rather than receiving bags of grain, families receive money or vouchers that they can spend at local markets. This approach supports local farmers and businesses at the same time as helping those in need.

Research from crisis zones in both Africa and the Middle East suggests that cash-

based aid can be just as effective at reducing hunger while doing less damage to local economies. However, cash aid also carries risks, particularly in areas where markets are broken or where security is poor.

The debate reflects a broader tension in development policy: how to meet urgent needs without removing the conditions that allow communities to eventually support themselves.

Aid experts say the answer is rarely one approach or the other, but rather a careful combination — one that responds to immediate suffering while actively planning for long-term recovery and local self-sufficiency.

한글 요약

부유한 국가들이 기아 위기 국가에 제공하는 식량 원조는 생명을 구하는 역할을 하지만, 현지 농민의 시장 경쟁력을 약화시키고 장기적인 빈곤과 원조 의존성을 심화시킬 수 있다는 우려가 커지고 있다. 이에 일부 인도주의 단체들은 직접 식량 배급 대신 현지 시장에서 사용할 수 있는 현금이나 바우처를 지급하는 방식으로 전환하여 지역 경제를 함께 지원하고 있다. 연구 결과에 따르면 현금 기반 원조는 기아 감소 효과는 유사하면서도 지역 경제에 미치는 피해가 더 적은 것으로 나타났으나, 시장 붕괴나 치안 불안 지역에서는 위험 요소도 존재한다. 원조 전문가들은 즉각적인 구호와 장기적인 자립을 동시에 고려하는 신중한 병행 접근이 필요하다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

humanitarian 인도주의적인

dependency 의존(성)

voucher 상품권, 바우처

self-sufficiency 자립, 자급자족

collapse 붕괴하다, 무너지다

crisis 위기

assistance 지원, 원조

Can Local Governments Stand on Their Own?

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 281 words · L2



지방 분권과 재정 자립

In many countries, power and money flow mostly from the central government down to local regions. But in recent years, more governments have been asking whether this system is still the best approach. The debate over decentralization — giving local governments more authority and financial independence — has become a key political issue in several nations.

Decentralization means that local governments take on more responsibility for decisions affecting their own communities. Instead of waiting for approval from the capital, local officials can set their own policies on education, transportation, or public services.

Supporters argue that local leaders understand the needs of their residents far better than distant central officials do.

However, greater authority only works when local governments have enough money to act on it. This is where fiscal independence becomes critical. A region that depends heavily on transfers from the central government cannot truly govern itself. Many local governments still rely on central funding for the majority of their budgets, which limits how freely they can plan.

Building fiscal independence is not simple. Local governments need strong tax bases, which means having enough businesses and residents to collect taxes

from. Rural or less developed areas often struggle here, since their economies are smaller. This creates an uneven situation where wealthier regions gain more from decentralization while poorer ones fall further behind.

Some experts point to successful models in Europe and North America, where local governments manage significant budgets and deliver services efficiently. These cases suggest that decentralization can work, but it requires careful planning and fair funding rules. For many countries still working toward this goal, finding the right balance between local freedom and national support remains the central challenge.

한글 요약

지방분권화는 지방 정부가 교육·교통·공공 서비스 등 주요 정책을 자율적으로 결정할 수 있도록 권한과 재정적 독립성을 부여하는 방식으로, 최근 여러 국가에서 핵심 정치 현안으로 부상하고 있다. 그러나 지방 정부가 실질적인 자치를 실현하려면 충분한 세원을 바탕으로 한 재정 자립이 선행되어야 하며, 중앙 재원에 대한 높은 의존도는 자율적 계획 수립을 제약하는 요인이 된다. 특히 경제 규모가 작은 농촌 및 낙후 지역은 세수 기반이 취약해 지방분권화의 혜택을 제대로 누리지 못하고, 오히려 지역 간 불균형이 심화될 수 있다. 유럽과 북미의 성공 사례는 지방분권화의 가능성을 보여 주지만, 효과적인 실현을 위해서는 신중한 계획과 공정한 재정 배분 체계가 반드시 수반되어야 한다는 점을 시사한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

decentralization 분권화, 권한 분산
fiscal 재정의, 재정에 관한
authority 권한, 권력
transfer 이전, 이체

budget 예산
residents 주민, 거주자
independent 독립적인

The True Cost of Chronic Disease

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 294 words · L3



만성 질환과 예방 의료의 경제학

Chronic diseases such as diabetes, heart disease, and cancer are among the leading causes of death worldwide. They also place an enormous financial burden on national healthcare systems and on the broader economy.

A chronic disease is a long-term condition that usually cannot be cured but can be managed. Unlike infectious diseases, chronic conditions often develop slowly over years, driven by lifestyle factors such as poor diet, physical inactivity, tobacco use, and excessive alcohol consumption.

When large numbers of people live with chronic illness, the costs to a country go far beyond hospital bills. Workers miss days at their jobs, retire early, or become

unable to work at all. This loss of productivity can reduce a nation's GDP by a significant amount over time.

Economic modelling shows that investing in chronic disease prevention pays off strongly. When governments fund programs that encourage healthier eating, regular exercise, and routine health screenings, fewer people develop serious conditions later in life. This reduces the need for expensive treatments and hospital stays.

Analysts point out that prevention spending tends to generate returns that outweigh the initial cost. In other words, spending a smaller amount now to keep people healthy can save a much larger amount in future medical expenses.

One point worth noting is that the economic benefits of prevention take years to appear. This makes it harder for policymakers to justify the spending in short budget cycles, even when the long-term case is strong.

Another interesting factor is the indirect savings from a healthier workforce. Healthier employees are more productive, take fewer sick days, and stay in the workforce longer — all of which contribute to economic growth. For these reasons, many health economists argue that prevention is not just a medical issue but an economic strategy.

한글 요약

당뇨병, 심장 질환, 암 등 만성 질환은 전 세계적으로 주요 사망 원인이자 국가 의료 시스템과 경제 전반에 막대한 재정적 부담을 초래한다. 만성 질환을 안고 생활하는 인구가 늘어날수록 생산성 손실로 인해 국가 GDP까지 감소하는 결과를 낳는다. 경제 모델링 분석에 따르면 예방 프로그램에 대한 투자는 미래의 고비용 치료비를 절감시켜 초기 지출을 상회하는 효과를 창출한다. 그러나 예방의 경제적 편익은 수년에 걸쳐 나타나기 때문에, 단기 예산 주기에 묶인 정책 입안자들이 관련 지출을 정당화하기 어렵다는 과제도 존재한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

chronic 만성적, 장기적인
productivity 생산성
prevention 예방
modelling 모델링, 모형 분석

policymakers 정책 입안자들
screening 검진, 선별 검사
outweigh ~보다 크다, ~을 능가하다

When School Skills Don't Match Job Needs

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 128 words · L1



직업 교육과 산업 수요의 불일치

Many graduates leave school ready to work, but employers say they are not prepared enough. In industries like technology, manufacturing, and healthcare, companies struggle to find workers with the right skills. This gap between what schools teach and what jobs require is a growing concern worldwide.

Vocational schools train students for specific careers, but their courses often fall behind changes in industry. New tools and technologies appear faster

than schools can update their programs. As a result, graduates sometimes need extra training after they are already hired.

Experts say stronger partnerships between schools and businesses could help close this gap. When companies work directly with schools to design courses, graduates are better prepared from day one. Several countries are already testing such programs, and early results look promising.

한글 요약

전 세계적으로 학교 교육과 산업 현장이 요구하는 역량 사이의 격차가 심화되고 있으며, 기업들은 적합한 기술을 갖춘 인재를 확보하는 데 어려움을 겪고 있다. 특히 직업학교의 교육 과정이 빠르게 변화하는 산업 환경을 따라가지 못해, 졸업생들이 취업 후에도 추가 훈련을 받아야 하는 사례가 늘고 있다. 전문가들은 학교와 기업이 교육 과정 설계 단계부터 협력함으로써 이 격차를 효과적으로 줄일 수 있다고 강조한다. 일부 국가에서는 이미 산학 협력 프로그램을 시범 운영 중이며, 초기 결과가 긍정적으로 평가되고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

graduate 졸업생, 졸업하다

vocational 직업과 관련된

industry 산업

manufacturing 제조업

partnership 협력 관계

update 최신화하다, 업데이트하다

promising 유망한, 가능성 있는

Better Forest Management Can Reduce Wildfire Damage

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 119 words · L1



산불 대응과 산림 관리 정책

Wildfires are becoming more frequent and more destructive around the world. Rising temperatures and longer dry seasons are creating conditions where fires start more easily and spread faster than before.

Experts say that better forest management is one of the most effective ways to reduce the damage. Clearing dead trees and dry brush removes fuel that

fires need to grow. Controlled burns — small fires set on purpose — can also lower the risk by reducing the amount of material that could catch fire.

Many governments are now increasing funding for these prevention efforts. Specialists note that no single method can stop wildfires completely, but combining different strategies gives firefighters a much better chance of keeping fires under control.

한글 요약

기온 상승과 장기화된 건기로 인해 전 세계적으로 산불이 더욱 자주, 더욱 큰 규모로 발생하고 있다. 전문가들은 고사목 및 건조한 덩불 제거, 계획 화입 등 적극적인 산림 관리가 피해를 줄이는 데 효과적이라고 밝혔다. 각국 정부는 이러한 산불 예방 활동에 대한 재정 지원을 늘리고 있는 추세다. 전문가들은 단일 방법만으로는 산불을 완전히 차단할 수 없으며, 복수의 전략을 복합적으로 활용하는 것이 화재 통제에 훨씬 유리하다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

frequent 자주 발생하는, 빈번한
destructive 파괴적인
management 관리
controlled 통제된, 조절된

prevention 예방
strategy 전략
fuel 연료, 불쏘시개

Undersea Cables Keep the World Connected

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 120 words · L1



해저 케이블과 통신 안보

More than 95 percent of the world's international internet traffic travels through undersea cables on the ocean floor. These cables connect countries and continents, carrying everything from everyday messages to major financial transactions.

Despite their importance, the cables are surprisingly easy to damage. Ships' anchors, underwater earthquakes, and intentional damage have all caused serious outages in recent years. A single break can

disrupt communications across an entire region for days or even weeks.

Countries are now working harder to protect these critical systems. Governments are increasing patrols in key areas, and engineers are developing underwater sensors to detect damage more quickly. Keeping these cables safe has become an urgent global security concern that affects people and economies around the world.

한글 요약

전 세계 국제 인터넷 트래픽의 95% 이상을 담당하는 해저 케이블은 각국과 대륙을 잇는 핵심 통신 인프라이다. 그러나 선박의 닻, 해저 지진, 의도적 훼손 등으로 인해 손상에 취약하며, 단 한 번의 절단으로도 광범위한 통신 장애가 수일에서 수주까지 이어질 수 있다. 이에 각국 정부는 주요 해역 순찰을 강화하고, 엔지니어들은 피해를 신속히 탐지하기 위한 수중 센서 개발에 박차를 가하고 있다. 해저 케이블 보호는 오늘날 전 세계 경제와 안보에 직결된 시급한 국제적 과제로 자리매김하고 있다.

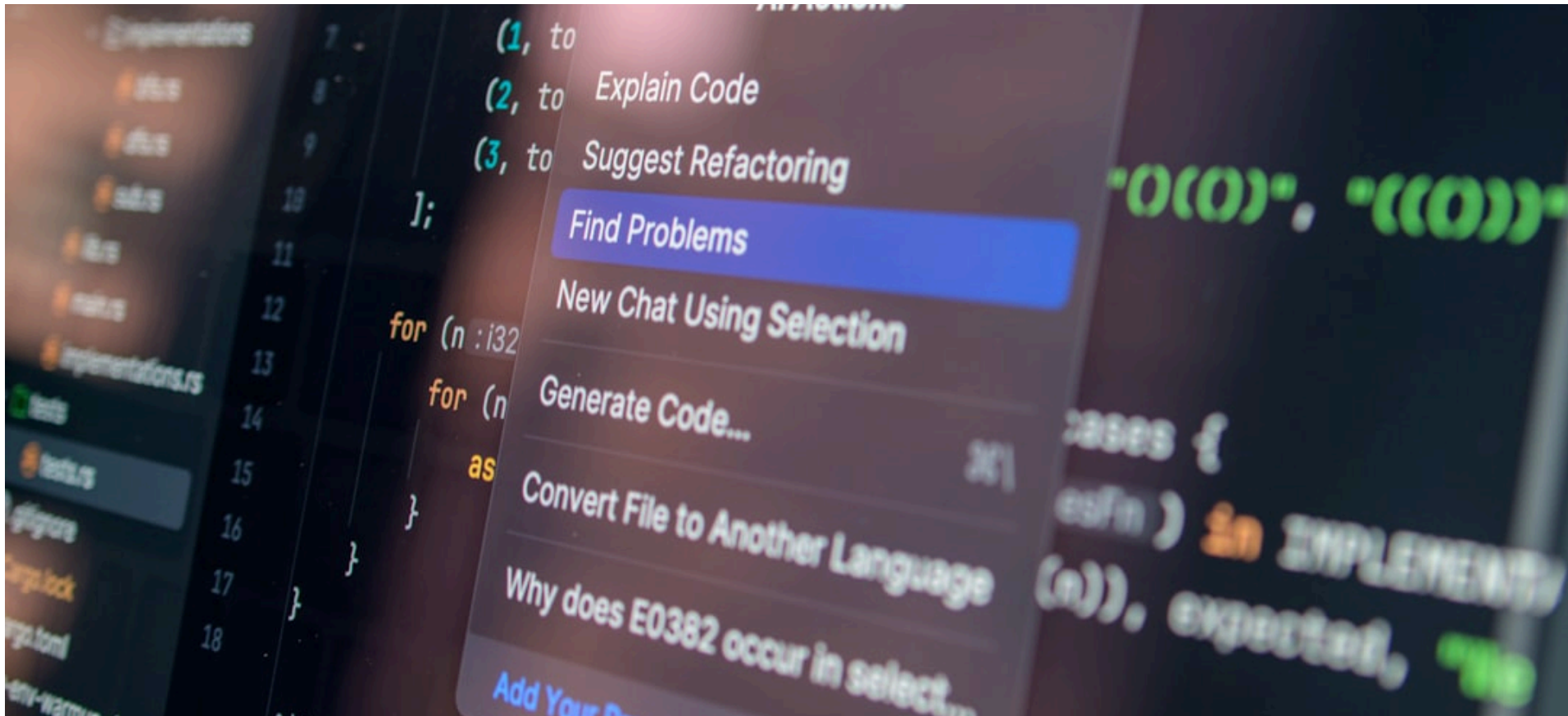
WORDS & MEANINGS

fiber-optic 광섬유의
transaction 거래
deliberate 의도적인
outage 중단, 정전

infrastructure 기반 시설
sensor 감지기, 센서
detect 감지하다, 탐지하다

AI Translation Tools Reshape Interpreter Jobs

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 137 words · L1



AI 번역이 바꾸는 통번역 직업

AI translation tools have become much more powerful in recent years. Apps and software can now convert speech or text between languages in seconds. This is changing the job market for professional translators and interpreters around the world.

Research shows that AI tools have already reduced work for some freelance translators. One study found that after ChatGPT became widely available, translation job volume dropped by roughly 9 percent.

Many companies now use AI tools for routine translation tasks instead of hiring people.

However, human translators are still needed in many areas. In medical or legal settings, small mistakes can have serious consequences, and AI tools are not yet reliable enough for these situations. Experts say that translators who learn to work alongside AI may actually become more productive. The job is changing, but it is not disappearing.

한글 요약

AI 번역 도구의 급격한 발전으로 전 세계 번역·통역 시장에 구조적 변화가 나타나고 있다. 연구에 따르면 ChatGPT 보급 이후 번역 업무량이 약 9퍼센트 감소하는 등 AI가 이미 고용 시장에 실질적인 영향을 미치고 있다. 다만 의료·법률 등 고도의 정확성이 요구되는 분야에서는 AI의 한계로 인해 인간 번역가의 역할이 여전히 필수적이다. 전문가들은 AI를 효과적으로 활용하는 번역가는 생산성이 향상될 수 있으며, 번역 직종 자체는 소멸하지 않을 것이라고 전망한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

interpreter 통역사

freelance 프리랜서, 독립 계약직

routine 일상적인, 반복적인

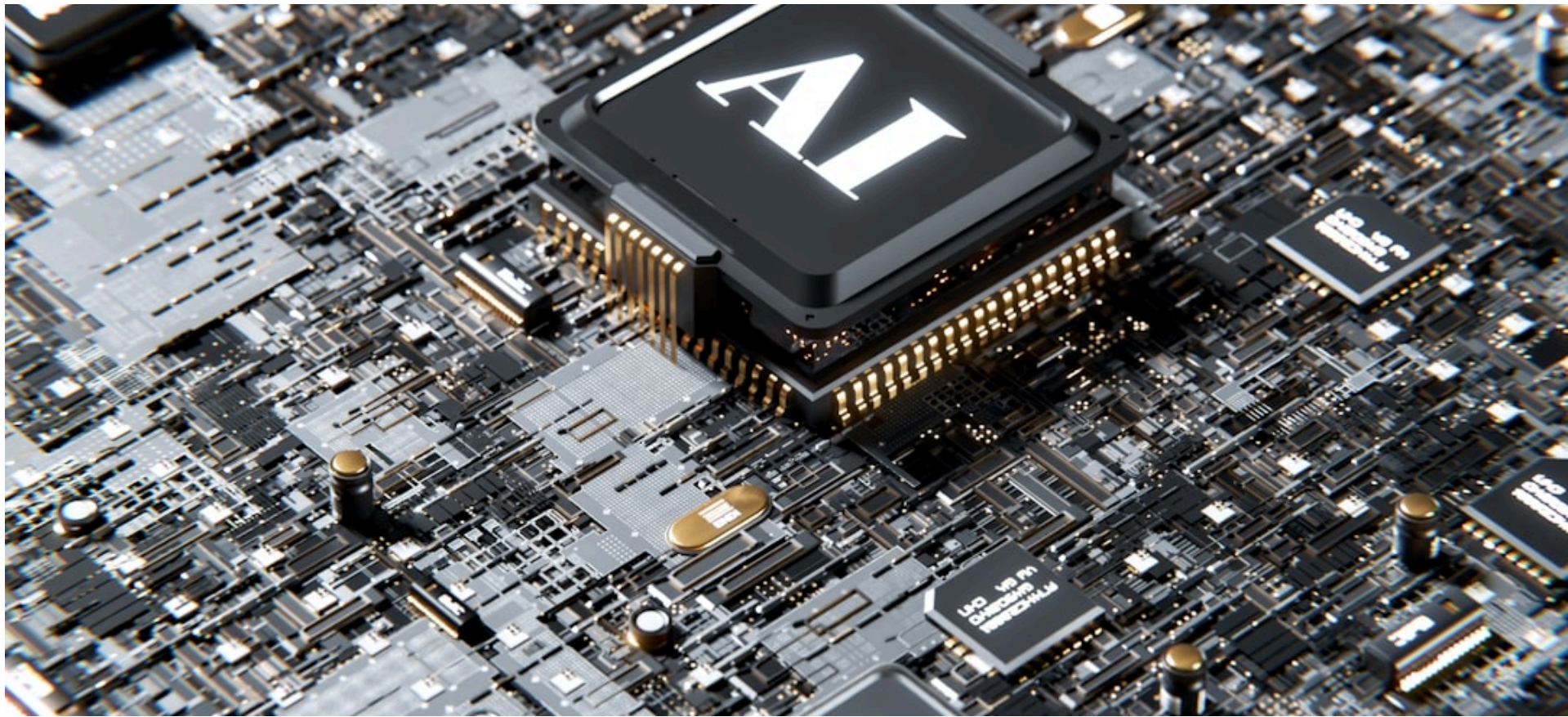
reliable 믿을 수 있는, 신뢰할 수 있는

productive 생산적인

consequence 결과, 영향

The Race to Subsidize Semiconductors: Worth the Cost?

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 288 words · L3



반도체 보조금 경쟁의 득실

Governments around the world are spending billions of dollars to build domestic semiconductor industries. The United States, the European Union, Japan, and South Korea have all launched major subsidy programs in recent years, hoping to secure their own supply of chips.

Semiconductors are tiny electronic components that power everything from smartphones to military systems. Because so much of global chip production is concentrated in Taiwan and South Korea, many governments grew worried about supply chain risks — especially after chip shortages hit the auto and electronics industries hard during the COVID-19 pandemic.

The U.S. responded with the CHIPS and Science Act of 2022, committing roughly \$52 billion to support domestic chip manufacturing and research. Supporters say the law has already helped create over 120,000 jobs and encouraged major companies to invest in new factories on U.S. soil.

However, critics point to serious challenges. Funding has been slow to reach companies, and building advanced chip factories requires highly skilled engineers that many countries simply do not have enough of. Intel, which received significant U.S. government support, still ran into major financial difficulties.

Analysts also warn that competing with Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing

Company, known as TSMC, is extremely difficult. TSMC produces the most advanced chips in the world and benefits from decades of expertise and a deep local talent pool.

There are broader concerns as well. Some economists argue that large government subsidies can distort markets and lead to wasteful spending if political priorities drive funding decisions rather than economic ones.

Still, many governments see chip independence as a matter of national security, not just economics. Whether these costly programs will deliver lasting results remains an open question — and one that will shape the global technology landscape for decades.

한글 요약

코로나19 팬데믹 이후 반도체 공급망 리스크가 부각되면서 미국, EU, 일본 등 주요국들이 자국 반도체 산업 육성을 위한 대규모 보조금 프로그램을 경쟁적으로 추진하고 있다. 미국은 2022년 반도체·과학법을 통해 약 520억 달러를 투입하며 일자리 창출과 공장 건설을 유도하고 있으나, 자금 지원 지연과 전문 인력 부족 등 구조적 난관에 직면해 있다. 수십 년의 기술력과 인재풀을 갖춘 TSMC와의 경쟁이 현실적으로 쉽지 않은 데다, 일부 경제학자들은 정치적 논리에 의한 보조금 지원이 시장 왜곡과 재정 낭비를 초래할 수 있다고 경고한다. 각국 정부는 반도체 자립을 국가 안보의 문제로 간주하고 있으나, 이러한 대규모 투자가 장기적으로 실효성 있는 결실을 맺을 수 있을지는 여전히 불확실하다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

semiconductor 반도체
subsidy 보조금
domestic 국내의
supply chain 공급망

shortage 부족, 공급 부족
distort 왜곡하다
expertise 전문 지식, 전문성

스크랩하기Scrap It!

이름날짜학교 · 반

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